



Report of the 25th Meeting of the World Flora Online Council Geneva, Switzerland, 12th September 2025

The 25th meeting of the World Flora Online (WFO) Council was held in person with online virtual participation on Friday 12th September 2025, attended by 40 people (11 in person, 29 online) from 18 countries, representing 22 Consortium Members. The Council meeting was preceded by an Extraordinary Meeting of the WFO Council and the inaugural meeting of the WFO Executive Committee on 12th September, reported separately. The meetings were hosted by the Botanic Garden of Geneva, Switzerland.

Consortium Member representatives present:

Adil Güner	Nezahat Gökyiğit Botanik Bahcesi, Istanbul, Turkey
Alex Monro	Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, London, UK
Dalila Espírito-Santo ^V	University of Lisbon, Lisbon, Portugal
Dinesh Kumar Agrawala ^V	Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata, India
Domingos Cardoso ^V	Universidade Federal da Bahia, Salvador, Brazil
Eric Schuettelpelz ^V	Smithsonian Institution, Washington DC, USA
Francesco Roma-Marzio ^V	University of Pisa, Pisa, Italy
Geoffrey Levin ^V	Flora North America Association, Ottawa, Canada
Lauren Raz	Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Bogotá, Colombia
Marianne Le Roux ^V	South African National Biodiversity Institute, Pretoria, South Africa
Mark Watson	Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK
Martin Ricker ^V	National Autonomous University of Mexico, Mexico City, Mexico
Mauricio Bonifacino	IAPT, Montevideo, Uruguay
Nicola Schönenberger	Conservatoire et Jardin Botaniques, Geneva, Switzerland
Peter Fritsch ^V	Botanical Research Institute of Texas, Texas, USA
Peter Moonlight ^V	Trinity College Dublin, Dublin, Ireland
Peter Wyse Jackson	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Pierre Bonnet ^V	PI@ntNet, Montpellier, France
Santiago Madriñan ^V	Jardín Botánico de Cartagena, Bolivar, Columbia
Thomas Borsch	Botanic Garden and Botanical Museum Berlin-Dahlem, Berlin, Germany
Visotheary Ung ^V	Muséum National d'Histoire Naturelle, Paris, France
Xiaohua Jin ^V	Institute of Botany, Beijing, China

In attendance:

Agathe Pineau ^V	École Estienne, Paris, France
Alan Elliott	WFO TEN Manager, Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK
Andreas Müller ^V	Botanic Garden and Botanical Museum Berlin-Dahlem, Berlin, Germany
Catherine Martin ^V	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Chuck Miller ^V	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Eve Lucas ^V	Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, London, UK
Gunter Fischer ^V	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Jordan Teisher	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA

Nancy Morin ^v	Flora of North America Association, California, USA
Nathan VanderKroats ^v	Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Nicky Nicolson ^v	Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, London, UK
Nye Hughes ^v	Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK
Ogün Demir ^v	Nezahat Gökyiğit Botanik Bahcesi, Istanbul, Turkey
Raoul Palese	Conservatoire et Jardin Botaniques, Geneva, Switzerland
Roger Hyam ^v	Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK
Ronell Klopper ^v	South African National Biodiversity Institute, Pretoria, South Africa
Thomas Haevermans ^v	Muséum National d'Histoire Naturelle, Paris, France
Tony Mast ^v	WFO Gatekeeper, Missouri Botanical Garden, St Louis, Missouri, USA
Walter Berendsohn ^v	Botanic Garden and Botanical Museum Berlin-Dahlem, Berlin, Germany

^v = virtual

The following is a summary report of the meeting of Council and decisions adopted. Presentations given at the meeting and associated documents are available on the WFO OwnCloud online storage, <https://cloud.worldfloraonline.org>

1. Welcome

Council Co-chair Mark Watson began the meeting and welcomed all participants who were attending in person and online. He thanked Nicola Schönenberger and his team at the Botanic Garden of Geneva for hosting the meeting. Nathan VanderKroats and Eric Schuettpeitz were welcomed as new Council members of Council and gave introductions.

The following draft agenda, with modifications made during the meeting, was adopted as follows:

1. Welcome by Co-chairs *Peter Wyse Jackson, Lauren Raz & Mark Watson*
2. Apologies for absence
3. Adoption of the Minutes of the 24th WFO Council meeting
4. New WFO Consortium Members *Peter Wyse Jackson*
5. WFO Association registration and update *Nicola Schönenberger*
6. TEN Manager and Taxonomic Working Group report *Alan Elliott & Mark Watson*
7. Report from the WFO Gatekeeper *Tony Mast*
8. Report from the Use Cases Review Task Force *Marianne LeRoux*
9. Report from the Portal 2.0 Task Force *Tony Mast*
10. Report from the Geographical Distribution Task Force *Alex Monro*
11. Report from the Identification Task Force *Eve Lucas*
12. Report from the Communications Working Group *Catherine Martin*
13. Review of priority action points from the last meeting
14. Arrangements for the 26th WFO Council meeting, hosted by the Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata, India, February 2026
15. Presentation on Flora of Uruguay project *Mauricio Bonifacio*
16. Any other business
17. Concluding remarks

2. Apologies for absence

Apologies for absence from the meeting were received from Olaf Bánki (Catalogue of Life), Ethan Freid (Bahamas), Joe Miller (GBIF), John Parnell (Ireland), Alan Paton (UK), Marc Sosef (Belgium), and Visotheary Ung (Paris).

3. Adoption of the report from the 24th meeting of the WFO Council

The report of the 24th WFO Council meeting, held at the Leon Levy Native Plant Preserve, on Eleuthera, The Bahamas, 20-21 February 2025 was adopted with minor corrections, the addition of a missing recommendation from the Identification Task Force Report and a missing Action Point for the Technical Working Group, and will be posted on the WFO About Pages.

4. New Consortium members

Peter Wyse Jackson listed the new incoming members of the Consortium that has signed the WFO MOU since the last Council meeting. They would be receiving letters of welcome shortly:

- InfoFlora, at the Botanic Garden of Geneva, Switzerland
- La Laguna Botanic Garden, El Salvador
- Jardín Botánico Real de Madrid, Spain

WFO continues to receive expressions of interest in becoming WFO members from other organisations and institutions worldwide.

5. WFO Association registration and update

Nicola Schönenberger reported that WFO was established as an Association on 11 September 2025 at the Constitutive General Assembly in the Botanic Garden of Geneva. The General Assembly approved the adoption of the Association's statutes and approved the composition of the Executive Committee. The WFO Council Co-chairs were elected as Co-Presidents of the Association, with Nicola Schönenberger as Secretary, and Raoul Palese as Treasurer. Mauricio Bonifcino and Visotheary Ung were elected as auditors for the 2025 fiscal year. WFO will be a legal entity with capacity to raise funds in the service of its strategic plan. The first meeting of the Executive Committee was held after the General Assembly. This considered the internal organisation of the committee, the frequency of meetings, and the financial administration. The minutes of this and the General Assembly were recorded separately, and are available on the WFO OwnCloud.

Joe Miller and Olaf Bánki sent a written message from the Global Biodiversity Information Facility (GBIF) and Catalogue of Life (CoL), jointly congratulating WFO on achieving the significant milestone of establishing WFO as a legal entity in Switzerland. They stressed that both CoL and GBIF are strong supporters of the World Flora Online, and they would like to investigate how to collaborate on a shared global plants taxonomic resource for the world, as it would be most efficient to find a common approach, and closely link and support the round tripping of taxonomic data between our infrastructures.

They noted that taxonomy will be recognized at the G20 Research and Innovation Ministerial in Pretoria later in September, where the Ministerial proclamation will affirm the importance of initiatives such as The Catalogue of Life and GBIF as a critical response to the need for accessible and comprehensive biodiversity information resources.

6. TEN Manager update and Taxonomic Working Group report

Alan Elliott, WFO TEN Manager, provided an update on progress made since the last meeting (see presentation on OwnCloud). The June 2024 edition of the WFO Plant List was published on time, with the addition of 9.5K additional names and 216K names with edited data. There are now over 1M synonym records, and 30 TENs made new contributions for this version. Further details are here <https://about.worldfloraonline.org/june-2025-release>.

The total number of TENs is up to 63, covering 403 families and 54% of all accepted species. The uptake of managing data curation in Rhakhis is increasing with 7 training sessions held over the past 6 months. The following three proposals for new TENs have been received with several more in the pipeline.

- Hydnoraceae: 2 genera, 14 species
- Monimiaceae: 27 genera, 274 species
- Velloziaceae: 6 genera, 308 species

The About Pages have been updated with new partner and new approved TEN pages.

Mark Watson, co-chair of the Taxonomic Working Group, continued the report (see presentation on OwnCloud) and gave summary of the joint discussion topics. The proposal from the Boraginales TEN to split Boraginaceae into 11 families was approved and recommended to Council. Proposals for three new TENs was also recommended to Council for authorisation. These recommendations were both accepted by Council.

Discussions continue with IPNI and WCVF towards moving the curation of classification data from WCVF onto WFO, with IPNI as the nomenclatural source of vascular plant data. Kew are documenting the data pipelines used for WCVF which will inform this. The recommendation that the Taxonomic Working Group establish a General Curatorial Team using *Tropaeolum* as a test case was approved.

Recent changes to the spelling of names in IPNI have raised the issue how to treat orthographic variants in WFO. The recommended action is to correct the spelling in the existing record in WFO (hence preserving the WFO-ID to IPNI-ID link) and create a new record in WFO for the original spelling. The Technical Working Group agreed to discuss this matter and give their recommendation at the next meeting of Council.

The Taxonomic Working Group discussed suggestions from Nasjia Kortokova for enhancing the accreditation of contributor curation of the consensus classification. It was agreed that WFO should remain inclusive in including people on authorship listings, and that TEN leads would be encouraged to review those to include from their group. The recommendation that an Action Point be raised for the Taxonomic Working Group to continue to explore ways of crediting contributions to WFO products was approved by Council.

Three manuscripts have been accepted for the TAXON articles relating to IBC Madrid, 2024. Two are still outstanding. It was agreed a two month deadline would be given to authors and that we should go with what we have after this.

Council decisions on Taxonomic Working Group recommendations

- 1) Council to approve the recognition of Boraginaceae sensu lato as 11 families **APPROVED**
- 2) Council to authorise TENs for Hydnoraceae, Monimiaceae, and Velloziaceae **APPROVED**
- 3) Council to approve the development of a General Curatorial Team using *Tropaeolum* as a test case **APPROVED**
- 4) Council to approve the creation of an Action Point to consider contributor accreditation **APPROVED**

7. Report of the WFO Gatekeeper

Tony Mast, the WFO Gatekeeper, presented a report on work undertaken since the last meeting (see presentation on OwnCloud). The portal servers faced major problems since May due to automated bots scraping data from WFO sites, overloading the servers and rendering the website unusable. As this automated traffic was overwhelmingly from China, reaching daily user counts of over 63,500 a day from China in August, which compares to total of about 50,000 globally for the month of April this year, a short-term fix was to block all traffic from China to Missouri Botanic Garden sites. This has now been replaced by enhancing the system so that it only allows entry to human users (Captcha). The portal is now running stably, but a warning is displayed on the homepage alerting users to potential slowdown issues. The Geoserver and OwnCloud are running normally.

The mailing lists have been amended and additional users added, increasing users by 10%. Amendments for the mailing lists should be sent to tony.mast@mobot.org. Work is ongoing to deploy the inclusion of Pl@ntNet identification utility, which is currently in Test. Work is needed to link to species in WFO rather than GBIF. The Contributor Guides have been updated to include Rhakhis.

The June taxonomic backbone and content were harvested and made live on the portal on 2 September. Solanaceae data have been added, as have images from Leon Levy. 12.5% of the ParseGIF specimen data have also been added. The ingestion of new Content is a priority, but had to be put aside during the summer to deal with server issues.

The backlog of Content waiting to be harvested is being processed with Flora accounts prioritised. Harvesting status report (Action Item 6):

Flor. Trop. East Africa & Fl. Trop. West Africa (Kew)	Harvested
IUCN Conservation Status	Harvested
Improve Metadata for Images from Solanaceae & Flora of China	Solanaceae second version harvested

Solanaceae Source	Harvested
NYBG	Harvested
Catalogo de las Plantas de Colombia	Harvested
Australian Floras	Harvested
Flore du Gabon and Flore d'Afrique centrale	Harvested
Flore du Gabon and Flore d'Afrique centrale	Harvesting into Stage, in preparation to harvest into Production
Flora of Cambodia	Theory is working with Alan Elliott on name matching
GBIF Specimen Data	Harvesting into stage is 50% complete and paused due to the extreme size of the files/data causing issues with SOLR indexing. Paused to harvest other data into production while a solution is being researched and tested.
Plants of Nepal checklist	Harvesting into Stage, in preparation to harvest into Production
Illustrated Treatments for Korea	Last response - coordinating to convert Word documents into structured data
Flora Helvetica	French Descriptions received and are being prepared to harvest into stage
Flora do Brazil	more descriptions being provided.
eMonocot descriptions (Kew, TBC)	PalmWeb descriptions pending harvesting
New FNA data	3/24 - Got data and content sample. Issues with Authors format. Reviewed file's DwCA format. Repeated Name Matching process as requested. Harvested
African Plants Database	3/24 - African Plants Database – (distributions, ecology, biology) 200K names, 78K taxa. - Pending.
eFloramaghreb.org	6400 taxa – Pending.
Flora of Ireland	Awaiting updated content
Irish Names	Harvested
Caryophyllales	Harvested Nepenthes taxa. Pending other taxa and all content from EDIT platform.
South Africa	Harvested

8. Report of the Use Cases Review Task Force

Marianne Le Roux presented a report on behalf of the Use Case Review Task Force which has completed its work and delivered a written report in August (see presentation on OwnCloud).

Marianne presented an overview of the history of the WFO portal and the first use case document. The Task Force was created to update this document and to prioritise current user requirements, with a view to inform future accessibility to the data development of the portal. Users from the taxonomic, conservation and ecological communities were consulted from the viewpoint of data users, contributors of data or data managers. Several rounds of consultation resulted in use cases being scored 'Essential, Helpful or Unnecessary', alongside consideration of risks and dependencies. The TF recommended that the report be shared with the Taxonomic Working Group and the Geographic Distribution Task Force and feedback solicited.

Council decisions on Use Case Review Task Force recommendations

- 1) Council to share the Use Case Report with the Taxonomic Working Group and the Geographic Distribution Task Force and solicit feedback

APPROVED

9. Report of the Portal 2.0 Task Force

Tony Mast reported that the membership of the Portal 2.0 Task Force was not yet complete but will be established soon. Once the group is constituted it is anticipated that the work will take six weeks to complete to the review of current and future options for WFO infrastructure.

10. Report of the Geographical Distribution Task Force

Alex Monro presented a report on behalf of the Geographical Distribution Task Force (see presentation on OwnCloud). Spatial data is important as it adds value to WFO, helps WFO to contribute to meeting GSPC targets that require spatial data, and enables WFO to help the community prioritise and coordinate research and conservation efforts (an article in *Diversity & Distributions* proposes a framework for this prioritisation). Following discussions at the last Council, *Begonia* (with the help of Peter Moonlight) was used to test the ParseGBIF dataset, showing that it was of good quality. As reported by Tony Mast, the 23 million occurrence records in ParseGBIF are in the process of being uploaded into the WFO Geoserver. Kew is working on an updated version of the dataset, which will be available in December.

11. Report of the Identification Task Force

Eve Lucas presented a report on behalf of the Identification Task Force (see presentation on OwnCloud). The TF has developed a survey to guide prioritization of the incorporation and development of ID tools. The survey is in six languages (English, French, Hindi, Mandarin, Malay, Portuguese, Spanish) and will be sent out once a list of stakeholders has been developed.

The Pl@ntNet image ID tool is now integrated into the WFO Test Portal (see Tony Mast report above), and Pierre Bonnet is working with Solanaceae data with a view to automate integration of WFO data into Pl@ntNet. Tony Mast agreed to the request to share data with the TF. A pilot study looking at mobilizing data from publications to produce descriptions for WFO was successfully undertaken by Nicky Nicolson, including extracting trait data. The TF in association with Pl@ntNet has made an application to FRB CESAB IdeaShare 2025 for work on the use of AI to enhance plant identification worldwide.

12. Report of the Communications Working Group

Catherine Martin presented a report on behalf of the Communications Working Group (see presentation on OwnCloud). A communications mailing list is being developed to connect with the media teams of WFO consortium partners. This will be used to share social media posts, encourage resharing and solicit new news items. An email has been sent requesting partners to send their media team contacts to Catherine (cmartin@mobot.org). WFO is moving away from Twitter/X and over to Bluesky where we are building our following. Facebook continues to be strong (1800 followers and 35,000 views since February), and LinkedIn is gaining momentum as a platform for sharing news. Security on these platforms is being strengthened and additional administrators added. Posts linked to international days and new TEN announcements are the most popular. Nicola Schönenberger is working on an announcement of the formation of the WFO Association.

Promotional leaflets are now available in all UN languages, as well as Portuguese and Turkish. PDFs are available on the OwnCloud, and will be made available for download on the About Pages. Nicola (nicola.schoenenberger@geneve.ch) offered to make leaflets in other languages if the translated text is sent to him. Agathe Pineau gave a presentation on the animated film and graphics she has developed for WFO for her masters course in Scientific Illustration at the École Estienne, Paris. The Communications WG will be working with Agathe to develop her work for use in WFO.

13. Review of Action Points from the last meeting

Updates from Action Points not already covered elsewhere include:

1) Presentations and promotion opportunities

- EUROGARD, Roma, Italy September 2025 (Nicola to present on WFO)
- Living Data (TDWG/GBIF/OBIS/GEO BON), Bogotá, Colombia, October 2025 (Lauren will present on WFO, and other WFO people will be presenting in other sessions)

14. Arrangements for the 26th WFO Council meeting

The 26th meeting of WFO Council will be held at the AJC Bose Indian Botanical Garden, Howrah, near Kolkata., India, scheduled for 9-12 February 2026. The timing to coincide with the celebrations of BSI Foundation Day on 13th February. Details of the programme will be circulated as soon as they are ready.

15. Flora of Uruguay presentation

Mauricio Bonifacio reported on Flora of Uruguay project and demonstrated their online portal (about 1000 genera, 3000 spp. total), due to be launched in November. The portal has capacity to filter and download highly customized lists. It includes collections data from all five herbaria in Uruguay and data harvested from iNaturalist (images curated by the project), as well as keys, maps, specimens, descriptions and phenology. WFO can help with integrating synonymy.

16. Any Other Business

Chuck Miller announced that he would be retiring in the near future from his position at Missouri Botanical Garden. Peter Wyse Jackson acknowledged the huge contribution which Chuck has made to WFO and its success, and thanked him on behalf of Council for his work. Chuck wanted it recorded that the WFO logo and font was created by Robert Thurman, who at the time was based at MBG, but is now in Kentucky.

17. Concluding remarks

Peter Wise Jackson drew the meeting to a close by thanking our hosts, the team at Botanic Garden of Geneva, the WFO co-chairs of the Working Group co-chairs, Task Force leaders, TEN Manager, Gatekeeper, and all Council members who have joined online and in person.

Annex 1

ACTION ITEMS FROM 25th WFO COUNCIL MEETING – Geneva, September 2025

#	TASKS	WHO?	WHEN?	COMMENTS
1	Presentations on WFO. Take advantage of the meetings we attend to promote the WFO. Presentations to be uploaded to WFO Presentations folder in ownCloud.	All	Standing Item	Upcoming presentations: EUROGARD, Italy Sept 2025; Living Data, TDWG/GBIF/OBIS/GEO BON, Colombia, Oct 2025
2	Update MoU signatories. Secretariat to maintain an archive of all formal agreements with WFO. List of Consortium members on the WFO website to be updated.	Peter Wyse Jackson	Standing Item	The following new partners have joined the Consortium since the Feb 2025 meeting: InfoFlora, at the Botanic Garden of Geneva, Switzerland La Laguna Botanic Garden, El Salvador Jardín Botánico Real de Madrid, Spain
3	Social Media. Keep our social media channels updated with news and current information.	Comms Working Group	Standing Item	Send items for social media to Catherine Martin (Missouri BG)
5	Videos. Links to videos by partner institutions to be included on WFO About Pages.	All	Deleted as not necessary as a separate standing item	Send videos relevant WFO to Alan Elliott (RBG Edinburgh)
6	Enhance Production Portal with Descriptive Data. Production portal should be enhanced with descriptive data content, as advised by Taxonomic WG/Council, in order to increase the diversity of content and geographic coverage.	Tony Mast	Standing Item When ready, Tony Mast will touch base with the intermediary contacts of the Content providers for the next digital resources to harvest!	See Gatekeeper report for harvesting details. Notify Catherine Martin of new Content for promotion on Social channels
7	Create a Harvester administration/operations guide. The development of a Harvester administration/operation guide should be carried out immediately through testing and collaboration.	Tony Mast	Done	New updates should be included. Created documentation for “Name-Matching” process and made code and SQL Stored Procedures available for Geneva in Github (private MBG-CBI repository)
13	Taxonomic Expert Networks (TENs) 1) Encourage proposals of new TENs by contacting potential taxonomic experts and supporting them in the formulation of a TEN.	TEN Manager Alan Elliott	Standing Item	1) TENs approved by Council September 2025: Hydnoraceae; Monimiaceae; Velloziaceae

#	TASKS	WHO?	WHEN?	COMMENTS
	2) Highlight inactive TENS for consideration of removal. 3) Encourage all TEN leads/focals to subscribe to the TEN Mailing List			2) None of concern. 3) Done - significant increase in TEN leads in the mailing list
15	Develop markup Tools for a Toolkit. Consolidate the Markup Tools being used; develop them to integrate them into a toolkit. - SANBI has developed Markup tools and are available for others to use. Available from GitHub: github.com/rudivs/SpeciesMarkupAddIn	Technical Working Group	Deleted as no longer relevant	
18	Save the Dates of next meetings of Council	Peter Wyse Jackson	26 th Meeting, hybrid 9-12 February 2026 at Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata, India [relocated to Edinburgh UK]	Post the report of the 24 th Council Meeting on the WFO website.
33	Resolve insufficient resources to support: Software development staffing.	WFO Council	Ongoing	Missouri is committed to providing Tony Mast's role, but has an issue with software development staffing. Rhakhis software developed by Roger Hyam (RBGE). Ogün Demir (NGBB Istanbul) offered programming support.
48	Make modifications to the Portal 18. Assess how to provide page hit statistics by data provider. 28. Reveal hidden fields (e.g. Basionym) 29. Enable alternate classifications	Technical Working Group	Deleted pending outcome of Portal 2.0 review	18. Pending 28. Deferred at St. Louis 29. Deferred at St. Louis
80	Develop Criteria for judging authorisation of potential Content Providers	Taxonomic Working Group	Pending (revisit with strategic review)	Criteria (scientific credibility, completeness, substantial contribution, currency, etc.), similar to those used for assessing TENS. Another approach is to list what we would not accept.
81	WFO to give percentages of what data have been uploaded from what is published for each source of Content	Technical Working Group	Pending	Possibly include in a Content stock take and show against source in the Flora page in About Pages. Derive

#	TASKS	WHO?	WHEN?	COMMENTS
				percentages from table of content data records maintained by Tony Mast.
84	Contact Consortium Members to solicit additional Content datasets	WFO Council Co-chairs	Ongoing	
86	Explore formalising WFO's relationship with IPNI with a written agreement covering the nature of the collaboration and the exchange of data	WFO Council	Ongoing	Discussions ongoing with RBG Kew on integration of WCVP and links with IPNI.
106	Explore registration of WFO as an NGO in Switzerland	Nicola Schoenenberger	Done	
108	Review guidance on Data Downloads on the WFO website	Tony Mast, Alan Elliott	Pending	Replace text and downloads on 'Download Data' page of the WFO Portal with instructions on how Content and classification data can be downloaded, e.g. links to Zenodo, ChecklistBank, WFO Plant List, Portal downloads by registered users, etc.
111	Update Contributor Guides with latest data process changes after addition of Rhakhis.	Tony Mast, Roger Hyam	Done	
114	Consensus classification data development in Rhakhis 1) Incorporate updates from TENS 2) Update non-TEN groups with data from WCVP, or other published classifications approved by the Taxonomic WG 3) Report on deduplication in curation metrics	TEN Manager Alan Elliott	Standing item	June 24 to Dec 24 data cycle 1) 24 Angiosperm TEN. All ferns. All Bryophytes. 2) 17 WCVP families updated in this data cycle. 305 updated from WCVP 2.0 3) currently stands at around 4900 name pairs in Rhakhis integrity report. Homonyms with the same name string and author string are becoming more prevalent.
115	Consider modifications to the Family and Higher order classifications	Taxonomic Working Group	Ongoing	Activity on this is under Task 116

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116	Establishing a supra-order classification	Lauren Raz Taxonomic Working Group	Ongoing	Supra-order classification to be decided by Taxonomic WG and provided to Catalogue of Life. Higher classification under review, all bar Angiosperms done, to complete by next Council meeting.
117	Building a TEN global community 1) Develop an annual WFO TEN online symposium to share lessons learned and promote collaboration between TENS	Taxonomic Working Group	Ongoing	1) Seek to run an online symposium. Nadja Korotkova and Caryophyllales to organise the first of these in 2023. [not progressed yet]
118	IUCN Red List to adopt WFO Plant List as its accepted classification	Peter Wyse Jackson (Missouri and Kew)	Ongoing	WFO has requested to the IUCN Governor General to adopt WFO Plant List as the accepted classification used by IUCN for plant groups covered by WFO.
121	Create a subgroup to develop a Technical Strategic Plan	Technical Working Group	Next Council/Ongoing	Subgroup to create a short document that outlines the systems and people/roles involved in running the WFO now and for each one a “vision” of what will replace it/them either in case of emergency or as part of planned improvements. This plan will address WFO current technical infrastructure only.
126	Pursue strategic alliances with Xper3, GIFT, etc. for collaborating with identification resources	ID Task Force	Ongoing	To stimulate common efforts in developing a global plant character database, e.g, study the feasibility of using AI to data mine the WFO descriptive content.
128	Establish a task group to undertake the next steps towards integration of WCVP and WFO and report to Council	Council	Ongoing	Discussions ongoing with WCVP and IPNI.
130	Explore recognition of WFO as a Core Biodata Resource by Global Biodata Coalition	Taxonomic WG	Pending	Lauren Raz to look into Catalogue of Life experience with this and benefits it brings.

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132	Establish a Task Force to update the Use Case Report	Technical WG	Done	TF established and delivered report to Council in August
133	Establish a Task Force to review options for development of the WFO infrastructure and website	Technical WG	Next Council	TF is in process of establishment. Once started to complete work in 6 weeks.
134	Publication agreement with PhytoKeys	Thomas Borsch to lead	Ongoing	Thomas Borsch, Lauren Raz, Roger Hyam and Alan Elliott to continue discussions with PhytoKeys to explore this proposal and clarify doubts
135	African Plant Database collaboration discussions	Council Co-Chairs	Ongoing	To explore future closer collaboration and data sharing. Waiting on a proposal from Geneva
136	Pl@ntNet web tool to be embedded in the WFO Portal	Technical WG and ID Task Force	Next Council	Tool has been added to the Test Portal and being evaluated.
137	Assess how Pl@ntNet ID tools can be accommodated in WFO	Technical WG and ID Task Force		Work on this is focused under Task 136
137	Undertake a user survey to determine needs for plant ID tools	ID Task Force	Next Council	User survey has been composed in six languages and will be sent out soon
138	Test the ParseGBIF dataset with an active TEN	Geo Task Force	Done	<i>Begonia</i> dataset has been used as a test case with the help of Peter Moonlight.
139	Invite GBIF participation in the Geo Task Force	Geo Task Force	Done	
140	Create a content schedule for social media posts	Communications WG	Done	
141	Council members to connect their communications staff with the Communications WG	Communications WG and all Council Members	Done	Mailing list has been compiled and is being added to

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142	Promotional leaflets to be produced in Arabic, Russian and Chinese	Communications WG – Geneva BG	Done	Geneva developed these leaflets, printed sets and put PDFs on the OwnCloud
143	Investigate incorporation of AI-based services into WFO Portal 2.0	Technical WG	Deferred to decision on Portal 2.0	
144	Report on the handling of orthographic variants of scientific names (new)	Technical WG	Next Council	
145	Explore contributor accreditation in WFO products (new)	Taxonomic WG	Ongoing	Refer to suggestions by Nadja Korotkova
146	Develop promotional video(s) and WFO graphics/brand (new)	Communications WG	Next Council	Work with Agathe Pineau to build on her artwork and video promoting WFO.
147	Post digital versions of the WFO promotional leaflets on the About Pages (new)	WFO TEN Manager	Next Council	Add to the documents page.
148	Approach BGCI as a potential WFO Partner and content provider (new)	Peter Wyse Jackson	Next Council	